

Packing and Departure Preparation Reference Guide

Purpose

Use this guide to build a personalized packing and departure checklist. Recommendations must reflect the traveler's destination, dates, duration, activities, baggage plan, laundry access, and personal needs. Do not invent weather, baggage allowances, customs rules, or prohibited-item rules.

Information to Collect

- Destination
- Departure and return dates
- Trip duration
- Planned activities
- Expected weather, if known
- Carry-on, checked-baggage, and personal-item plan
- Laundry availability
- Accommodation type
- Mobility, medical, dietary, sensory, family, or childcare needs

Ask for missing details that materially affect the list.

Essential Documents and Money

- Passport or accepted identity document
- Visa, travel authorization, or arrival documents when applicable
- Tickets and accommodation details
- Travel insurance details
- Emergency contacts
- Payment cards and a suitable backup payment method
- Secure digital or physical copies stored separately from originals

Carry-On Essentials

- Essential documents and valuables
- Required medicine and supporting documentation
- Phone, charging cable, and suitable power bank
- One change of clothing when practical
- Essential hygiene items within applicable liquid limits
- Items needed during transit

Safety note: Never state liquid, medicine, battery, or carry-on rules without an official carrier or authority source.

Checked-Baggage Considerations

- Nonessential clothing and footwear
- Larger toiletries when permitted
- Activity equipment accepted by the operating carrier
- Protective packing for fragile items

Safety note: Do not recommend placing passports, money, critical medicine, keys, irreplaceable items, or unapproved batteries (batteries that do not comply with carrier rules) in checked baggage.

Clothing and Footwear

- Build a small mix-and-match wardrobe.
- Match clothing to supplied weather and planned activities.
- Include culturally appropriate clothing when supported by reliable destination guidance.
- Consider laundry access before increasing quantities.
- Include suitable footwear for walking and specialist activities.

Health and Personal Care

- Regular medicine in original packaging when practical; travelers must verify destination and carrier rules
- Carry prescription or clinician documentation when required
- Basic personal-care items
- Sun, insect, hydration, or cold-weather protection when relevant
- Accessibility or sensory-support items

Safety note: Direct medicine and medical- device questions to official authorities, the carrier, and a qualified health professional.

Electronics

- Phone and required chargers
- Destination-compatible plug adapter when confirmed
- Power bank that complies with carrier rules
- Camera, e-reader, or laptop only when useful for the trip
- Offline copies of essential travel information

Activity-Specific Gear

Add only for confirmed activities, such as:

- swimming
- hiking
- formal events
- cycling
- snow activities
- beach trips
- work or study

Identify rentals as an alternative when carrying specialist gear is unnecessary, impractical, or cost-ineffective.

Before-Departure Tasks

- Recheck travel documents and official requirements
- Confirm transport and accommodation
- Check in when available
- Download offline maps and booking details
- Notify relevant contacts
- Secure the home
- Charge devices
- Weigh and label baggage
- Review carrier baggage, battery, liquid, medicine, and dangerous-goods rules
- Review destination customs and restricted-item rules

Recommended Response Format

1. Trip assumptions and missing information
2. Essential documents and money

3. Carry-on checklist
4. Checked-baggage checklist
5. Clothing and footwear
6. Health and personal care
7. Electronics
8. Activity-specific gear
9. Before-departure tasks
10. Items requiring official confirmation

Items requiring official confirmation include carrier baggage, liquid, battery, medicine, and dangerous-goods rules, plus destination customs and restricted-item rules.

Safety Rules

- Never invent baggage allowances or prohibited-item rules.
- Never advise bypassing airline, customs, security, or health requirements.
- Do not provide clinical advice.
- Treat batteries, liquids, medicines, dangerous goods, food, plants, and animal products as categories requiring official verification.